



BRAC University

Department of Mathematics and Natural Sciences

LECTURE ON

Real Analysis II (MAT321)

Uniform Convergence and Continuity

Property of Uniform Convergence, Continuity of Limit Function

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CONDUCTED BY

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Convergence of Sequence in Real Numbers

Convergence of a Sequence

A sequence $\{a_n\}$ is said to **converge** to a real number a if for every real number $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists a natural number $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $n \geq N$, the terms of the sequence satisfy the inequality

$$|a_n - a| < \varepsilon.$$

If such a number a exists, it is called the **limit** of the sequence, and we write

$$\lim a_n = a \quad \text{or} \quad a_n \rightarrow a \text{ as } n \rightarrow \infty.$$

Cauchy Criterion for Convergence

A sequence $\{a_n\}$ is said to satisfy the **Cauchy criterion** if for every real number $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists a natural number $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $m, n \geq N$, the terms of the sequence satisfy the inequality

$$|a_n - a_m| < \varepsilon.$$

Note: A sequence that satisfies the Cauchy criterion is called a **Cauchy sequence**. In the real numbers, every Cauchy sequence converges to a limit, and every convergent sequence is a Cauchy sequence.

Limit and Continuity of a function

Limit of a Function

Let $f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a function defined on a subset A of the real numbers, and let c be a limit point of A . We say that the **limit** of $f(x)$ as x approaches c is equal to L , and we write

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = L,$$

if for every $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists a $\delta > 0$ such that for all $x \in A$ with $0 < |x - c| < \delta$, we have

$$|f(x) - L| < \varepsilon.$$

Continuity of a Function

A function $f : A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is said to be **continuous** at a point $c \in A$ if

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = f(c).$$

In other words, f is continuous at c if for every $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists a $\delta > 0$ such that for all $x \in A$ with $|x - c| < \delta$, we have

$$|f(x) - f(c)| < \varepsilon.$$

Poinwise Convergence and Uniform Convergence

Pointwise Convergence

A sequence of functions $\{f_n\}$ defined on a domain D is said to **converge pointwise** to a function f on D if for **every** $x \in D$ and for every $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists a natural number $N \in \mathbb{N}$ (which may depend on x and ε) such that for all $n \geq N$, the following inequality holds:

$$|f_n(x) - f(x)| < \varepsilon.$$

In this case, we write

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f_n(x) = f(x) \quad \text{for all } x \in D.$$

Uniform Convergence

A sequence of functions $\{f_n\}$ defined on a domain D is said to **converge uniformly** to a function f on D if for every $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists a natural number $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $n \geq N$ and for all $x \in D$, the following inequality holds:

$$|f_n(x) - f(x)| < \varepsilon.$$

In this case, we write

$$f_n \rightarrow f \text{ uniformly on } D.$$

Note: In uniform convergence, the choice of N depends only on ε and not on x , which is a stronger condition than pointwise convergence.

Uniform Convergence implies Pointwise Convergence

Theorem

If a sequence of functions $\{f_n\}$ converges uniformly to a function f on a domain D , then it also converges pointwise to f on D . 

Uniform Limit of Continuous Functions is Continuous

Theorem

Let $\{f_n\}$ be a sequence of functions defined on a domain D , and suppose that each f_n is continuous at a point $c \in D$. If $\{f_n\}$ converges uniformly to a function f on D , then f is also continuous at the point c .

❓ Problem

Show that $f_n(x) = x^n$ is not uniformly convergent on $[0, 1]$.



Interchange of Limits under Uniform Convergence

💡 Interchange of Limits for Sequence

Let $\{f_n\}$ be a sequence of functions that converges uniformly to a function f on a set $D \subset \mathbb{R}$, and let x_0 be a limit point of D . Suppose that for each $n = 1, 2, 3, \dots$,

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f_n(x) = a_n$$

exists. Then:

1. the sequence $\{a_n\}$ converges, and
- 2.

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} a_n.$$

💡 Interchange of Limits for Series

Let $D \subset \mathbb{R}$ and let $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} f_n$ be a series of functions defined on D whose partial sums

$$S_N(x) = \sum_{n=1}^N f_n(x)$$

converge uniformly on D to a function $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. Let x_0 be a limit point of D . Assume that for each $n = 1, 2, 3, \dots$ the limit

$$\lim_{\substack{x \rightarrow x_0 \\ x \in D}} f_n(x) = a_n$$

exists. Then:

1. the numerical series $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n$ converges, and
- 2.

$$\lim_{\substack{x \rightarrow x_0 \\ x \in D}} f(x) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n.$$

When Pointwise Convergence is Uniform Convergence

Dini's Theorem

Let K be compact, and $f_n : K \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ continuous. Suppose $f_n \rightarrow f$ pointwise on K , f is continuous, and the convergence is monotone (either $f_n \uparrow f$ or $f_n \downarrow f$ pointwise). Then $f_n \rightarrow f$ uniformly on K .

Problem

Show that $f_n(x) = \tan^{-1}(nx)$ is uniformly convergent on $[a, b]$ for $a > 0$, but not uniformly convergent on $[0, b]$.

❓ Problem

Let $x \geq 0$ and define $f_1(x) = \sqrt{x}$, $f_{n+1}(x) = \sqrt{x + f_n(x)}$. Discuss uniform convergence on (i) $[a, b]$ with $0 < a < b$ and (ii) $[0, 1]$.

Thank You!

We'd love your questions and feedback.

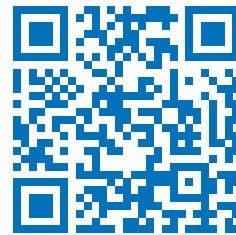
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(Lectures, walkthroughs, and course updates)



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References

- [1] Stephen Abbott, *Understanding Analysis*, 2nd Edition, Springer, 2015.
- [2] Walter Rudin, *Principles of Mathematical Analysis*, 3rd Edition, McGraw-Hill, 1976.